

PROGRAM ASSESSMENT REPORT

v2023.21 current

Tracking data

CIM code	MPA-PADM
Program name	Master of Public Administration
academic year	2023-2024
Program assessment coordinator	Roland Calia
Assessment plan year	2024-2025
No assessment this year per plan	☐
LO(s) assessed	Critical Thinking, Knowledge of Public Administration Theories, Knowledge of Financial Management Theories
Presented at program authority meeting date: <i>Please attach minutes</i>	To Be discussed in Fall 2025

Methodology

For each LO and artifact assessed, please describe the methodology used, and attach or insert the rubric used. At minimum this should contain:

- a description of how the artifact is concordant with the LO
- a description of the method used to place individual students in at least 3 assessment categories {**D** Does not meet expectations, **M** Meets expectations *M*, **P** Proficient} based on the artifact(s) assessed.

Objective: Students will develop well-reasoned arguments.			
Rubric Statement: Students will develop well-reasoned arguments supported by evidence.			
Construct	Exceeds Expectations (3 points)	Meets Expectations (2 points)	Does Not Meet Expectations (1 point)
Develops clear argument supported by evidence	Develops a clearly articulated argument, using evidence and/or systematic logical reasoning in support of a conclusion or point of view.	Presents argument using evidence and/or logical reasoning in support of a point of view.	Does not clearly state a conclusion or point of view or else little or no supporting reasoning or evidence is presented.
Identifies and prioritizes evidence evidence for argument	Identifies relevant qualifications or objections or alternative points of view and prioritizes evidence and/or reasons in support of the conclusion.	Identifies some qualifications or objections or alternative points of view.	Makes little or no attempt to recognize or respond to objections or alternative points of view.
Provides context for argument	Describes the broader relevance, significance or context of the issue and/or applies the reasoning to a novel problem.	Describes the broader relevance, significance or context and/or applies the reasoning to a novel problem.	Makes little or no attempt to describe the broader relevance or significance or to apply the reasoning to a novel problem.

Knowledge of Financial Management Rubric: Master of Public Administration Students				
Goal: Students will demonstrate knowledge of financial management theories and their application in practice.				
Objective: Students will understand how financial management theories and practices apply in the public sector				
Rubric Statement: Students will be able to describe and evaluate key financial management theories and practices				
Construct	Exceeds Expectations (3 points)	Meets Expectations (2 points)	Does Not Meet Expectations (1 point)	Score
The financial condition of a public organization	Student was able to describe and evaluate the financial condition of a public organization	Student was able to describe the financial condition of a public organization	Student was unable to describe or evaluate the financial condition of a public organization	
Budget documents and concepts of public organizations	Student was able to describe and evaluate public budget documents and concepts	Student was able to describe public budget documents and concepts	Student was unable to describe public budget documents and concepts	
Basic fund accounting principles and financial reports of public organizations	Student was able to describe and evaluate basic public fund accounting and financial reports	Student was able to describe basic public fund accounting and financial reports	Student was unable to describe or evaluate basic public fund accounting and financial reports	
The role of politics in the financial management process in the public sector	Student was able to describe and evaluate the role of politics in the public financial management process	Student was able to describe the role of politics in the public financial management process	Student was unable to describe or evaluate the role of politics in the public financial management process	
The role of planning in public budgeting processes in the public sector	Student was able to describe and evaluate the role of planning in the public budget process	Student was able to describe the role of planning in the public budget process	Student was unable to describe or evaluate the role of planning in the public budget process	

Knowledge of Public Administration Theories Rubric: Master of Public Administration Students

Goal: Students will demonstrate knowledge of public administration theories and their application in practice.
Objective: Students will understand theories of the appropriate role of the political and administrative actors in U.S.

Rubric Statement: Students will Students will be able to describe, evaluate and apply public administration theories

Construct	Exceeds Expectations (3 points)	Meets Expectations (2 points)	Does Not Meet Expectations (1 point)	Score
Conflict between political and administrative values	Students was able to describe, evaluate and apply theory regarding conflict between political and administrative values	Students was able to describe and evaluate theory regarding conflict between political and administrative values	Students was able to describe theory regarding conflict between political and administrative values	
The appropriate role of political and administrative actors	Student was able to describe, evaluate and apply theory regarding the appropriate role of political and administrative actors;	Student was able to describe and evaluate theory regarding the appropriate role of political and administrative actors;	Student was able to describe theory regarding the appropriate role of political and administrative actors	
How political control of the bureaucracy is ensured	Student was able to describe, evaluate and apply theory regarding how political control of the bureaucracy is ensured;	Student was able to describe and evaluate theory regarding how political control of the bureaucracy is ensured	Student was able to describe theory regarding how political control of the bureaucracy is ensured;	
Methods of popular participation in public administration	Students was able to describe, evaluate and apply theory regarding methods of popular participation in public administration;	Students was able to describe and evaluate theory regarding methods of popular participation in public administration;	Students was able to describe theory regarding methods of popular participation in public administration;	
The role of the expert in public administration	Students was able to describe, evaluate and apply theory regarding the role of the expert in public administration	Students was able to describe and evaluate theory regarding the role of the expert in public administration	Students was able to describe theory regarding the role of the expert in public administration	

Results

Artifact samples

Attach artifact samples. For data sets with ≤ 10 students, provide 1 in each category (unless the category is empty, if so state that). For programs with ≤ 20 , provide 2. For other programs provide 3.

Critical Thinking Goal – Assignment = Final Evaluation Memo



barrythomas_13002
_318143_Policy Evalu

Knowledge of Public Administration Theories – Assignment = Proposal Memorandum



Anurag_Proposal
Memorandum.pdf

Knowledge of Financial Management Theories – Assignment = Financial Condition Analysis Question #3



Financial Analysis
Assignment _Anuja I

Data table

For each LO assessed provide a table pasted in from the provided [recommended reporting template](#) placing each student into the assessment categories (minimally {D, M, P}). Provide a summary graph from the [recommended reporting template](#) (provided separately) presenting this distribution. You may also present additional analysis as deemed appropriate by the results seen and the needs of the program.

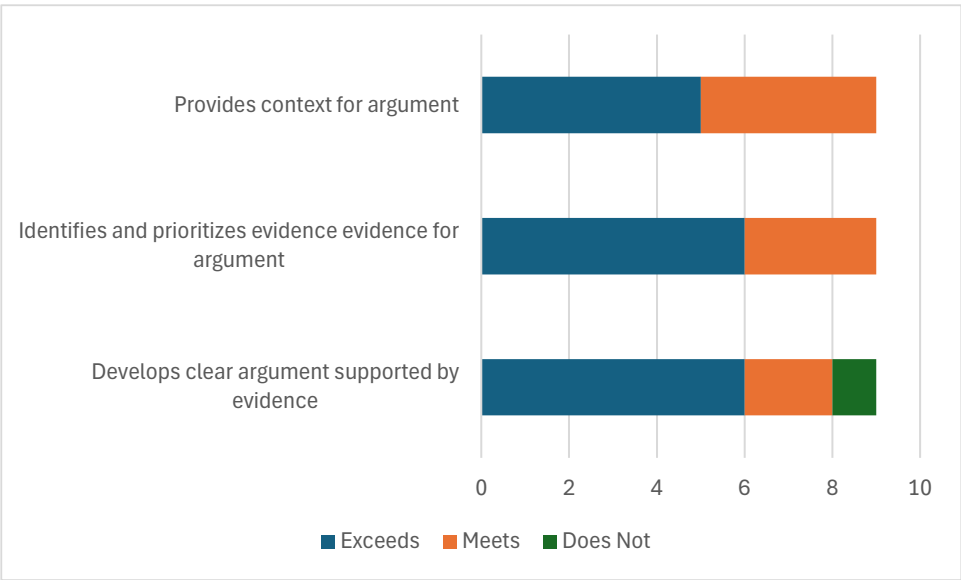
PA 580: Policy Forecasting and Evaluation

Goal: Critical Thinking - Develops Clear Arguments

Assignment: Final Evaluation Memo

Fall 2024

Criteria	Count	Exceeds Expectations	Meets expectations	Does not meet expectation
Develops clear argument supported by evidence	9	67%	22%	11%
Identifies and prioritizes evidence evidence for argument	9	67%	33%	0%
Provides context for argument	9	56%	44%	0%

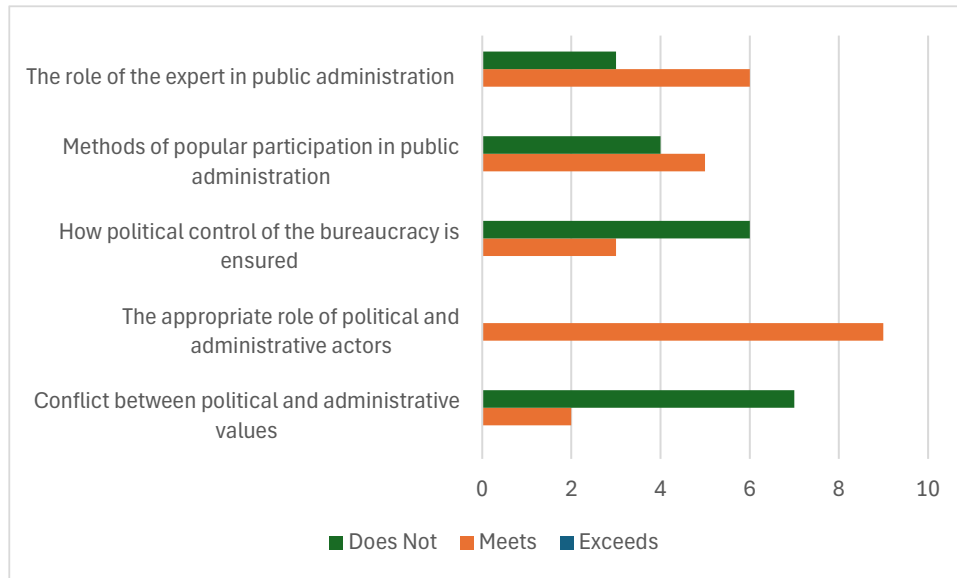


PA 501: Introduction to Public Administration

Goal: Knowledge of PA Theories

Assignment: Proposal Memorandum on Final Topic
Fall 2024

Criteria	Count	Exceeds Expectations	Meets expectations	Does not meet expectation
Conflict between political and administrative values	9	0%	22%	78%
The appropriate role of political and administrative actors	9	0%	100%	0%
How political control of the bureaucracy is ensured	9	0%	33%	67%
Methods of popular participation in public administration	9	0%	56%	44%
The role of the expert in public administration	9	0%	67%	33%



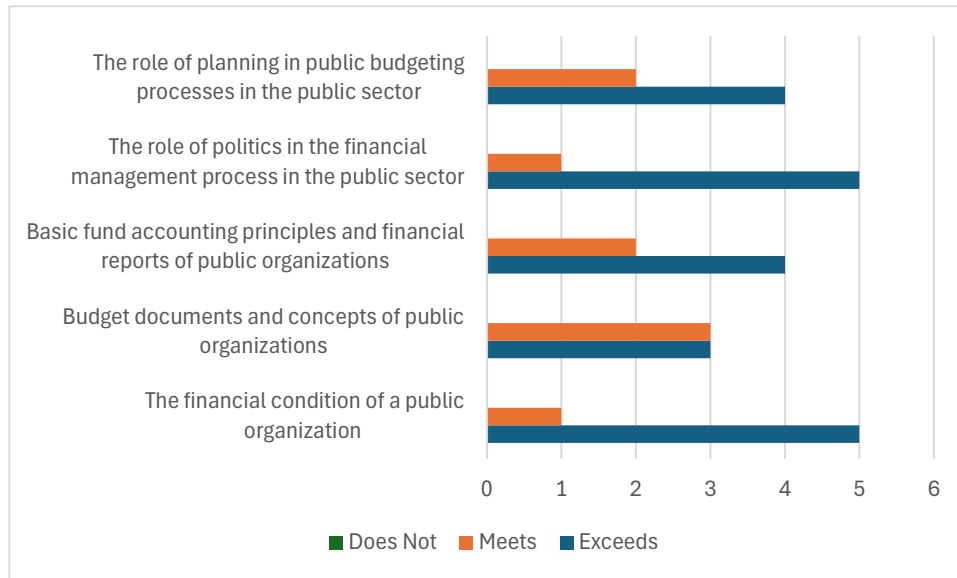
PA 532: Public Financial Management

Goal: Knowledge of Financial Management Theories

Assignment: Financial Condition Analysis Question #3

Fall 2024

Criteria	Count	Exceeds Expectations	Meets expectations	Does not meet expectation
The financial condition of a public organization	6	83%	17%	0%
Budget documents and concepts of public organizations	6	50%	50%	0%
Basic fund accounting principles and financial reports of public organizations	6	67%	33%	0%
The role of politics in the financial management process in the public sector	6	83%	17%	0%
The role of planning in public budgeting processes in the public sector	6	67%	33%	0%



Description of findings

Summarize the discussion that occurred within the program authority when this was presented. Provide a short narrative interpreting the findings. Are there any areas of concern?

PA 580 Critical Thinking

The average score on all 5 constructs was 80% meeting or exceeding expectations. Students met or exceeded the goal on all constructs.

Knowledge of Public Administration Theories

The average score on all 5 constructs was 56% meeting or exceeding expectations. Students met expectations only one construct - the appropriate role of political and administrative actors. There is needs to be significant improvement in this course to meet the learning objectives.

Knowledge of Financial Management Theories

The average score on all 5 constructs was well over 80% meeting or exceeding expectations. The course content is satisfactorily meeting the program goals.

Continuous Improvement, CI, plans

The purpose of assessment is to improve the quality of our educational programs. The most important part of the assessment cycle is how we use the data to improve our programs. Examine the data provided above describing student achievement, and if areas for possible improvement emerge, describe plans to achieve this improvement.

Prior CI plan impact

Refer to the previous assessment report for this LO. Were any CI plans recommended? Were they implemented? Did it work (were improvements seen in this cycle)?

Last year, we recommended revising the content of the PA 502 Organizational Behavior course as average score on all 4 constructs for the Knowledge of Organizational Behavior goal was 55% meeting or exceeding expectations. The course was completely revised in the 2024-2025 academic year, with a stronger focus on organizational behavior theories and their application to management. New readings and assignments we implemented.

Assessment of the policy analysis goal last year showed that only 63% met or exceeded expectations in understanding scenario planning (one of the goal constructs). The instructor revised assignments and content to improve student understanding of scenario planning in the 2024-2025 academic year.

☐ no previous CI plans available

This cycle's CI plan

Describe any CI plans developed from this cycle's data, as well as the strategy developed to implement these plans.

☐ After consideration and presentation to the program authority, no CI plans are recommended.

In the 2025-2026 academic year, the PA 501 Introduction to Public Administration course will be completely revised by the Program Director to address the deficiencies reported in the 2024-2025 report.